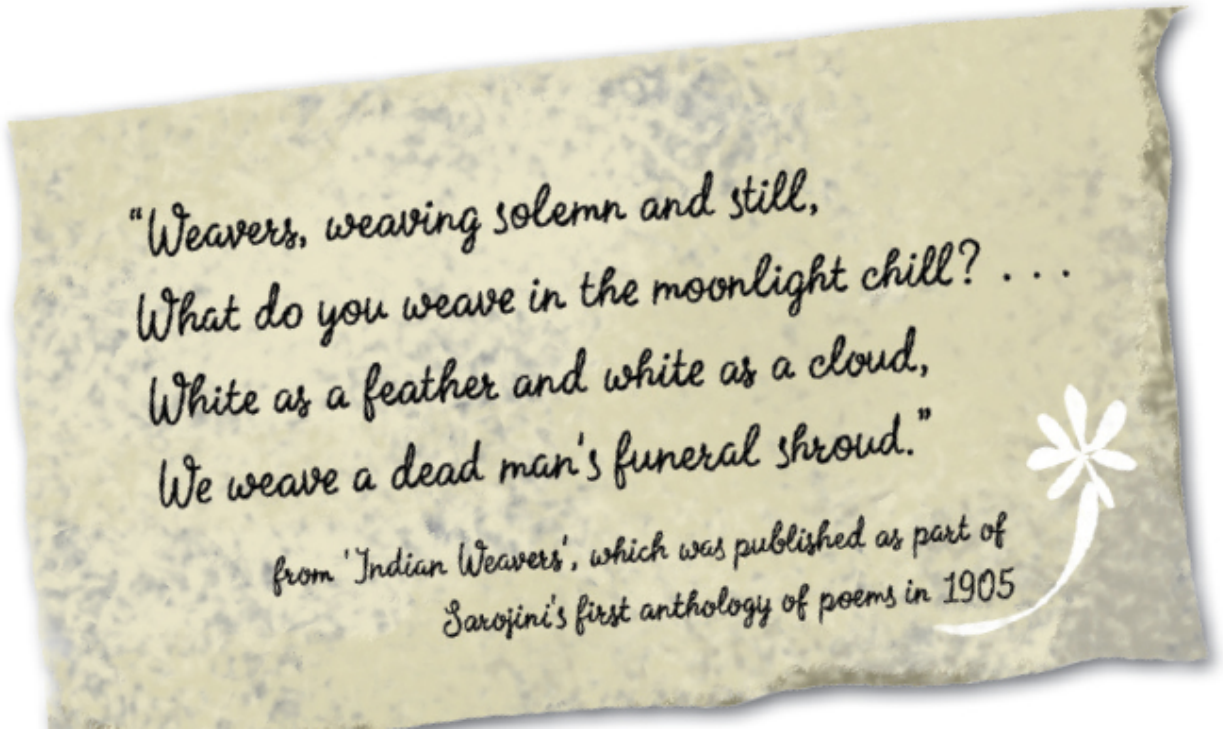
Sarojini Naidu was the eldest child of Aghorenath Chattopadhyay, a scholar and educationist, and Varada Sundari. Born in Hyderabad, Sarojini grew up in a liberal, cosmopolitan and progressive household. The Chattopadhyays often entertained scholars, politicians, activists and artists, and encouraged their children to read widely and cultivate many interests. Sarojini and her brother Harindranath would go on to become well-respected poets, while her other siblings pursued careers in the arts and education or dedicated themselves to revolutionary and political activities.



The nightingale of India

Sarojini began writing poetry while still a child, but her early poems were deeply influenced by English literary traditions. While studying in England, she was advised by the poet and literary critic Edmund Gosse to refocus her poetry on India—the world she came from and belonged to. Sarojini subsequently turned away from her earlier imitative poems, and instead began composing poetry that reflected the sights and sounds of the subcontinent, and drew on Indian folktales and myths. *The Golden*